

5. Funding

Rewritten after the full European sweep. Checked August 2026.

The short version

You are essentially self-funding, and that is survivable — because the cheapest real degrees in Europe cost €0–900 for the whole thing. The strategy is not to win a big scholarship. It is to **pick a country where tuition is near zero and then cover living costs**, with a scholarship as upside.

Two things to fix in your head before reading on:

1. **The Tunisian government grant is closed to you.** We led with it in an earlier draft and were wrong — the reasoning is below.
 2. **The real barrier is not tuition. It is the visa deposit** — France ~€14,500, Norway ~€14,600, Germany €11,904 — and almost nothing here can be used to satisfy it.
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The single best funding opportunity: Slovakia

Scholarships for Talented Students — €5,000/year x 2 = €10,000

- Open to **any non-Slovak citizen**, no age limit
- **EUBA's MSc Marketing and Trade Management is verified on the eligible list**
- Tuition at EUBA is already **€0**, so this is money for living costs
- Applied for **after enrolment**, so you fund the first weeks yourself
- Roughly **September 2027**; 20 master's places ring-fenced for Bratislava-region institutions

Why this one matters more than anything else here. The Ministry's methodological document states that for foreign applicants the **SAT (or SCIO) result is "the only evaluation criterion for constructing the ranking."** Your GPA is never consulted. No English certificate is required. Minimum SAT 1100, no section minimum.

Every scholarship in Europe screens on things you are weak at. This one screens on a test you can go and sit.

Second: Italy's fee system beats most scholarships

No competition, no panel, no deadline race — just means-testing, and on a Tunisian income you very likely qualify.

- **Bologna: ISEE <= €27,000 -> tuition €0, total ~€157/year**
- **Unimore: €159.67 · Bicocca: €346 · Pavia: €390 · Torino: €656**
- **Sassari waives year one entirely**

And there is a second route nobody had found. Besides ISEE — which needs Tunisian documents legalised at the Italian Embassy against a hard autumn deadline — Italy also assigns a **flat rate automatically from Tunisia's World Bank income band. No paperwork, no deadline risk**, and Tunisia sits in the lowest band nearly everywhere. **Pavia and Bicocca are the cheapest no-paperwork routes in Europe.**

! Milano Statale is the exception: ~€3,394/year, Tunisia is Group C, and ISEE parificato is explicitly forbidden — ten times Bicocca's price in the same city.

Correction: ER-GO is not special

An earlier draft presented ER-GO's **€7,171** as an Emilia-Romagna advantage and a reason to favour Bologna. **It is the national minimum every Italian region must match.**

EDISU Piemonte beats it: €8,096.78, plus **€6m ring-fenced for non-EU students** with ISEE <= €13,153 and **15% of first-year beds reserved for extra-EU students with family abroad**. Turin is better funded than Bologna, not worse.

Deadline calendar

When	What	Type	Odds
1 Dec 2026	INN Norway application	—	Most urgent date found
Oct–Dec 2026	Erasmus Mundus 2027 wave opens	Full funding	Varies
~Nov 2026	Stipendium Hungaricum opens	Tuition + stipend	Realistic
Early Nov 2026	File Denmark's free credential assessment	Enables Aalborg	Must do
~8 Jan 2027	Eiffel — your university must deposit your file	Full funding + fee exemption	Long-shot
~15 Jan 2027	Aalborg non-EU deadline (not 1 March)	~15 full awards, automatic	Realistic
~15 Jan 2027	Stipendium Hungaricum closes	Tuition + stipend	Realistic
~15 Jan 2027	Campus France closes	Mandatory gate	Must do
~26 Jan 2027	Corvinus Early Bird (10%, automatic)	Discount	Automatic
Jan–Feb 2027	Most Erasmus Mundus deadlines	Full funding	Varies
16 Feb – 31 Mar 2027	Romania MFA	Fully funded	Stretch
Feb 2027	CLIDE opens — latest EMJM window	Full funding	Realistic
Feb 2027	Re-check Malta's ODA course list — it resets annually	Full tuition + €1,300/mo	Worth a look
1 Mar 2027	Aalborg scholarship consideration	Automatic	Realistic
3 Mar 2027	FH Kufstein deadline	—	—
~26 Mar 2027	MAECI Italy	€10,800 / 9 months	Realistic–stretch
1 Apr 2027	Vilnius fee waiver (5 places)	Waiver	Long-shot
~May 2027	NAWA Banach, Poland	Tuition + PLN 2,500/mo	Realistic
23 Jun – 24 Aug 2027	ER-GO / EDISU regional grants	€7,171–8,097/yr	Realistic
~15 Jul 2027	Billboard France x Amazon Music	Full year, French institution	Stretch
~Sept 2027	Slovakia Talented Students	€10,000	Realistic
2 Sep – 1 Oct 2027	Estonia Harno (€350/mo)	Stipend	Stretch
~30 Oct 2027	ISEE filing, Italy	Fee exemption	Must do
1 Nov 2027	Andalucía authorisation receipt	Triggers the low fee	Must do
Oct–Dec 2027	Tunisian MESRS <i>prêt</i> — after you arrive	€120–145/mo loan	Realistic

The realistic list, ranked

- 1. Slovakia Talented Students — €10,000.** Covered above. Screens on the SAT, not your GPA.
- 2. Stipendium Hungaricum.** Tunisia holds **250 places**, entitlement is "*in any field of interest*". Covers tuition entirely plus dormitory. Stipend **HUF 43,700 ~ €110/month** plus ~€100 housing — the Call itself admits it "does not fully cover all the living costs." (Figures of HUF 200,000 online are the **PhD** rate.) **Apply even if pessimistic: it triggers an automatic 20% Corvinus discount regardless of the outcome.**
- 3. NAWA Banach, Poland.** Tunisia eligible, **no field restriction**, tuition exemption plus **PLN 2,500/month** and a PLN 2,500 travel allowance — a genuinely liveable stipend, unlike Hungary's.
- 4. Aalborg, Denmark.** ~15 fully-funded awards — tuition waiver plus **DKK 11,225/month** — by **automatic consideration**, no residence bar. Zero marginal cost to try.
- 5. Erasmus Mundus SDSI and CLIDE.** Tuition plus ~€1,400/month, max €33,600. SDSI has **no GPA floor, IELTS 5.5, and 5 places reserved for countries including Tunisia**. Note the €1,400 *includes* travel and installation, and awards are capped at ~10% per nationality — you compete against other Tunisians, not the world.
- 6. Regional Italian grants.** EDISU Piemonte €8,097 or ER-GO €7,171, stacking on near-zero tuition.
- 7. Billboard France x Amazon Music.** Funds one full year at a French institution, two awards annually. **Financial need is a key criterion; grades are not a published criterion at all**, and extra-curricular music is valued. The **only music-specific funding found in the entire project**, and the one place your self-taught production helps. Nationality conditions unpublished — email bourse@fr.billboard.com.
- 8. France's Eiffel.** €1,200/month for 24 months plus **automatic tuition exemption** worth another €3,950/year. **You cannot apply — your university must nominate you.** So the action is to ask each French international office **in writing, early**, before their internal selection closes. Long-shot on merit, but the ask is free.

The Tunisian instruments — what's true

The grant is closed to you

We led with this in an earlier draft. Verified against **Circulaire 61/25 of 23 October 2025**:

Condition	Reality
Grants for the whole EU	10 in total
Eligible fields	Energy transition, Industry 4.0, AI only
Minimum average	12.5/20 , not the 12/20 first reported
Record	No failed or repeated year, ever
Age	<=24 on 1 September
Status	Must be currently enrolled in year 3 — graduates excluded
Master's abroad	Must be a research master's

You fail at least five. (The amount is now €1,000/month under a July 2026 order — so anything quoting €800 is stale.)

The loan exists, but arrives too late to matter most

Nothing in the *prêt universitaire à l'étranger*'s conditions excludes you — no age bar, no field bar, no grade floor. From the JORT: **5,000 TND/year for Europe, 6,000 for France and Germany** (~€1,450–1,750/year, about €120–145/month). Repayment over ten years starting two years after the last disbursement. Means-tested, competitive, and requires a guarantor's *cautionnement solidaire*.

The catch is structural: it is for students *already enrolled abroad*. Applications open in late October and close in early December. So: admission spring 2027 -> arrival summer 2027 -> apply October 2027 -> **money in 2028. It cannot fund your visa deposit or first-year costs**, which is the barrier that actually decides where you can go.

Currency controls are not a problem. BCT circulaire 10-2025 permits 6,000 TND installation plus **4,000 TND/month** living costs plus tuition at invoice.

Bank study loans are effectively closed unless a *Plan Épargne Études* already exists, opened around 2024 (BIAT, STB, Amen, BT all require this). Otherwise the fallback is an ordinary parental loan.

Verified closed — do not chase

Scheme	Why
AUF (Agence universitaire de la Francophonie)	We flagged this as a strong prospect because you are francophone. Wrong, and structurally so — its student instruments are distance degrees, a doctoral scheme, and competitions. No AUF scholarship funds an individual's physical master's mobility to Europe
Norway — every institution	Nord "does not offer scholarships or grants"; INN "legally barred"; UiA "does not offer any scholarships for 2026/2027"; no national scheme since 2016
Swedish Institute	Tunisia is not among its 34 eligible countries (Egypt and Morocco are)
Austria — Ernst Mach / Erhard Busek	Ernst Mach does not fund full FH degrees; Erhard Busek is suspended . Cost Austria as self-funded
Islamic Development Bank	M.Sc. programme is Least Developed Member Countries only — Tunisia is not one
African Development Bank	Tunisia eligible, fields fit — but it funds study at African universities
OFID	Programme suspended
AFESD	PhD holders only
Mastercard Foundation	In Europe only Sciences Po, Oxford, Cambridge — all too selective
Aga Khan ISP	No Tunisia office
Qatar Foundation · Kuwait Fund	Doha only · sovereign lender, no student scheme
Chevening · DAAD EPOS	Both need 2 years' work experience — around 2029 for you
Erasmus+ KA171 · EIT Digital	3–6 month exchange, university applies · requires a technical bachelor — a marketing licence disqualifies
Lithuania · Slovenia · Croatia · Cyprus state schemes	Tunisia not listed; Cyprus requires 30 months' prior residence
Tartu waivers	Abolished from 2026/27
Malta ODA	Tunisia-specific and generous (€1,300/mo + full tuition) — but this year's eligible-course list is four science and humanitarian degrees. Re-check in February 2027
Istituto Italiano di Cultura Tunisi	States it administers no scholarships of its own

Empty categories, stated honestly: no Tunisian foundation or employer scheme exists, and there is **no marketing-specific scholarship for non-EU students anywhere in Europe**.

Still unverified

- The MESRS loan's **interest rate** — no governing text states one, but the CNSS loan charges 5%, so do not assume free. The parental income ceiling PDF would not load.
- **Billboard x Amazon Music nationality conditions** — unpublished.
- MAECI's Tunisia beneficiary status for 2027; AECID's possible public-employee restriction.
- Exact 2027 dates for most schemes — the calendar uses this cycle as an indication. **Re-check every date before relying on it.**